Investigating Earthquakes

Name/s: _____

At 10.27 am on 28 December 1989, Newcastle (Australia's sixth largest city at the time) was devastated by an earthquake measuring 5.6 on the Richter scale. It was the first earthquake in Australia that resulted in death and destruction - 13 people died, more than 160 people sustained injuries and over 10,000 buildings in Newcastle were damaged.

To find out more about earthquakes and the Newcastle example, use the following sites, and others of your choice, to answer the questions (you may need to type 'earthquake' into the sites' search facilities to find the information).

- University of Queensland (UQ) – www.uq.edu.au
- USGS (United States Geological Survey) website – earthquake.usgs.gov
- City of Newcastle website – www.newcastle.nsw.gov.au

All about earthquakes

1. What is an epicentre?

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2. What are the main causes of earthquakes?

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3. What tool is used to measure earthquakes?

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4. How does the measurement scale work?

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Newcastle earthquake

5. Where was the epicentre of the Newcastle earthquake?

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6. How far away from the epicentre was the Newcastle earthquake felt?

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7. What was the cause of the Newcastle earthquake?

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8. How did the emergency services react to the earthquake?

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9. How different would it have been if it wasn't school holidays when the earthquake struck?

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10. What can people do to protect themselves and stay safe during an earthquake?

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